CAPSTONE PROJECT | CONCEPT NOTE

DateNest

Personal Life Management System

One app. Every date. Zero missed deadlines.

Executive Education | Executive Program in Product Management (EPPM) | IIM Udaipur

Document Information	Details
Programme	Executive Program in Product Management (EPPM) - IIM Udaipur
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Document Purpose	Capstone Concept Note - Academic Submission & Presentation

A product concept for remembering important life dates early enough to act on them.

PRODUCT THESIS

DateNest combines the date, relevant context, a preparation window and the next action - rather than treating every important event as a generic reminder.

01 | Executive Summary

DateNest is a proposed personal life-management application designed around a simple everyday problem: important dates are scattered across calendars, messages, emails, documents, notebooks and individual service apps. Users may remember that something is approaching but still receive the reminder too late to take useful action.

The product brings important life events into one place and attaches relevant context to each date. Instead of treating every item as a generic calendar event, DateNest can store details such as an amount, policy number, relationship, vehicle information or required action. Its proposed Reminder Ladder gives users preparation time rather than only a last-minute alert.

The initial MVP focuses on four areas: Insurance & Policy, Home & Maintenance, Personal & Family, and Finance & Bills. Information can be added through permitted connected sources, guided entry, or manual entry. The capstone should validate the problem, test the core experience, and determine whether users value preparation-oriented reminders enough to adopt a dedicated solution.

PRODUCT-MANAGEMENT THESIS

DateNest should not be positioned as another generic reminder or task-management app. Its proposed differentiation is the life-event model: date + context + preparation window + next action.

02 | Problem Statement

People manage many recurring personal, financial, family and household dates. These include bill payments, insurance renewals, birthdays, anniversaries, document renewals, vehicle servicing, rent, appointments and other obligations. Today, these dates are often fragmented across multiple tools and services.

Current situation	User impact	Product opportunity
Dates live across calendars, chats, emails, documents and service apps.	Higher mental load and greater risk of forgetting.	Create one structured home for important life dates.
Generic events often contain only a title and date.	The user may not have the amount, reference number or required action when needed.	Attach relevant context to each life event.
A reminder may arrive only on or near the due date.	There may be insufficient time to arrange money, documents or other preparation.	Use a preparation-oriented Reminder Ladder.
Domain-specific apps know only their own category.	Users still need to remember the rest of life elsewhere.	Explore a cross-category personal life-management model.

IDENTIFIED PROBLEM

Individuals managing personal, financial, civic and family responsibilities lack a single, simple platform that consolidates important life dates and provides enough context and advance notice to act before a deadline becomes a problem.

03 | Objectives & Product Hypothesis

- Understand whether fragmented personal dates and late reminders represent a meaningful user problem.
- Design a simple life-event model that combines the date with the context and action required.
- Test whether preparation-oriented reminders create more value than a single generic notification.
- Identify the smallest viable MVP that can demonstrate the core value without overbuilding integrations.
- Establish measurable product outcomes for adoption, reminder response and task completion.

CORE HYPOTHESIS

If users can capture important life dates with relevant context and receive timely, category-appropriate reminders, they will be more likely to prepare and act before those dates than users relying on a single generic reminder.

04 | Target Users

The initial target is digitally active individuals who manage several personal responsibilities but do not want a complex productivity system. The segments below are hypotheses to be validated through primary research.

Segment	Typical needs	Potential DateNest value
Students & young adults	Fees, rent, exams, first financial obligations, family dates.	Simple setup and clear reminders.
Working professionals	EMIs, insurance, investments, vehicle service, family dates.	One place to manage multiple recurring obligations.
Families / household managers	School fees, household bills, appointments, staff/service dates, family occasions.	Shared visibility and category-specific context.
Older adults / caregivers	Pension-related dates, renewals, appointments, insurance and family events.	Large, simple interface and dependable reminders.

05 | Market Research & Problem Evidence

The following is secondary research used to support the problem hypothesis. It is directional evidence, not India-specific market sizing. Primary interviews and usability testing remain necessary before strong claims are made about demand, adoption or willingness to pay.

Source	Evidence	Implication for DateNest
YouGov, 2024	In a survey of 3,329 adults in Great Britain, 10% said they forget other people's birthdays "very often" and 27% "fairly often".	Forgetting important personal dates is a recognizable consumer problem.
Moonpig commissioned research	61% of surveyed Britons said they forget birthdays/anniversaries because they have so much going on; 45% of 16-29-year-olds said they had forgotten a parent's birthday.	Supports the idea that life overload contributes to missed personal dates; use cautiously because the research was commissioned by a gifting company.
Microsoft Research, 2017	Research on digital reminder systems found that people want support remembering a broad range of future activities and retrieving contextual details, not only simple time/location reminders.	Supports storing context alongside dates rather than treating every reminder as a generic alert.

Research caveat: Secondary sources establish problem relevance, but they do not establish the size of the Indian opportunity, willingness to pay, or product-market fit. Those claims should be validated through primary research.

06 | Competitive Landscape & Positioning

DateNest enters a mature reminder and productivity space. Therefore, the concept should not claim that reminders are new or that competitors have no comparable functionality. The stronger product argument is a focused combination of life-event context, preparation-oriented timing and India-relevant use cases.

Capability	Google Calendar	Any.do	TimelyBills / Axio	DateNest opportunity
General calendar / tasks	Strong	Strong	Focused on finance	Do not compete head-on.
Generic reminders	Yes	Yes	Yes	Table stakes, not the differentiator.
Structured life-event categories	Generic	General-purpose	Finance-focused	Make this a core experience.
Context attached to an event	Basic event details	Task-oriented	Finance-oriented	Build category-specific fields.
Preparation-oriented reminder ladder	Configurable reminders	Recurring reminders	Reminder-focused	Make timing + context central.
India-aware personal / civic context	General	General	Finance / India focused	Specialize where useful and validate.
Family-oriented life management	Shared calendars	Family / workspace features	Varies	Explore a simple life-management model.

POSITIONING STATEMENT

DateNest is a personal life-event management system that helps people remember what matters, understand why it matters, and prepare before the date arrives.

07 | Product Concept & Value Proposition

DateNest is envisioned as a mobile application for Android and iOS that acts as a single home for important life dates. The product concept is built around three connected entry modes and a structured life-event model.

Entry mode	How it works	User value
Automatic / connected entry	Where technically and legally feasible, permitted sources can surface relevant dates for user confirmation.	Less typing and faster setup.
Guided entry	The app asks only for fields relevant to a category, such as policy number, relationship or amount.	Structured information without a complex form.
Manual entry	Users create any custom date and choose an appropriate reminder pattern.	Flexibility for personal use.

MVP category structure

Category	Examples	Useful context
Insurance & Policy	Life, health, vehicle, term insurance	Policy number, renewal date, premium, vehicle.
Home & Maintenance	Rent, car service, appliance, household services	Provider, recurrence, amount, notes.
Personal & Family	Birthdays, anniversaries, family milestones	Person, relationship, date, notes.
Finance & Bills	EMIs, credit cards, utilities, recurring payments	Amount, due date, account/reference, recurrence.

08 | Core Feature - The Reminder Ladder

The Reminder Ladder is the central product hypothesis. The goal is not to increase notification volume; it is to create a preparation window appropriate to the type of life event.

Timing	Purpose	Example intent
30 days before	Preparation	Start keeping funds, documents or plans ready.
7 days before	Awareness	Show the full details and what needs to be prepared.
3 days before	Action	Give an urgent nudge and a clear next step.
1 day before	Final reminder	Make the deadline difficult to overlook.
On the day	Action prompt	Mark as done, snooze, or take the next action.
3 days after	Follow-up	Check whether the user completed the action, where appropriate.

IMPORTANT DESIGN PRINCIPLE

The ladder should be configurable by category. A birthday may require a different cadence from an insurance renewal or a bill. The product should optimize for useful preparation, not notification volume.

09 | User Journey - From Setup to Daily Value

The proposed journey is designed to reach meaningful value quickly while keeping setup effort low. The first experience should demonstrate the benefit of preparation before the user is asked to configure the full system.

Stage	User action	Expected experience
1. Discover	Understand the proposition.	Clear promise: one home for important life dates.
2. Quick setup	Choose categories and permission options.	Simple, transparent setup with clear consent.
3. Add dates	Use guided, connected or manual entry.	Relevant fields only; minimal typing.
4. See upcoming dates	Review next 7 / 30 days.	A calm overview of what needs attention.
5. Receive reminders	Get category-appropriate ladder notifications.	Context + preparation guidance, not just a date.
6. Act	Mark done, snooze or follow the suggested action.	Clear completion loop and reduced mental load.

10 | Key Differentiators & Validation

Differentiator	Why it matters	How to validate
Life-event model	Moves beyond title + date by capturing relevant context.	Compare task completion and follow-up questions against generic events.
Reminder Ladder	Creates preparation time rather than a single last-minute alert.	Prototype-test ladder vs. single reminder for preference and completion.
Category-specific setup	Reduces cognitive load by asking only relevant questions.	Measure completion time, errors and abandonment.
Automatic suggestions	Can reduce manual entry where permitted data sources contain useful dates.	Measure suggestion acceptance, accuracy and false positives.
India-aware use cases	Allows the concept to reflect relevant financial, civic and family contexts.	Validate through interviews and local use-case testing before expanding scope.

11 | Implementation Roadmap

The roadmap is intentionally phased. The capstone should demonstrate the core value before pursuing broad integrations or scale features.

Phase	Indicative scope	Primary outcome
Phase 1 - Validate & MVP	Problem interviews, prototype, four core categories, manual/guided entry, Reminder Ladder, upcoming-date dashboard.	Prove users understand and value the core concept.
Phase 2 - Pilot & Learn	Selected connected-source experiments, family sharing, widgets, India-specific date packs where validated.	Improve retention, trust and convenience.
Phase 3 - Scale	Broader integrations, multilingual support, smarter suggestions, document attachments and ecosystem partnerships.	Scale the validated product model responsibly.

12 | Success Metrics

Metrics should reflect the product's intended value: helping users act on important dates. Targets should be set after baseline research and pilot testing.

Metric	Type	What it tells us
Users who act on at least one reminder in a week	North Star candidate	Whether reminders lead to meaningful action.
Dates added in first session	Leading	Whether the product creates initial value.
Reminder response / completion rate	Leading	Whether alerts are useful and actionable.
Week 1 and Day 30 retention	Lagging	Whether the product becomes part of the user's routine.
Average active dates per user	Lagging	Whether users trust DateNest with meaningful life events.
Self-reported missed-date reduction	Outcome	Whether the product reduces the problem it set out to solve.

13 | Risks, Assumptions & Open Questions

Area	Key question / risk	Mitigation / next step
User need	Will users see enough value to move from existing calendar/reminder tools?	Conduct interviews and concept tests before building deeply.
Notification fatigue	Will multiple reminders become annoying?	Make the ladder configurable and measure mute / snooze behaviour.
Trust & privacy	Will users permit access to email, contacts or financial information?	Use explicit consent, minimum data collection and transparent controls.
Integration feasibility	Can relevant sources be connected reliably and legally?	Treat integrations as hypotheses; prototype only where access and permissions are available.
Market positioning	Is the concept too broad?	Start with a focused set of high-value life-event categories and expand based on evidence.
Business model	Will users pay, and for which value?	Test willingness to pay only after core value is demonstrated.

14 | Capstone Validation Plan & Next Steps

- Conduct qualitative interviews with target users to understand how they currently remember and manage important dates.
- Map the highest-frequency and highest-consequence life events, separating "nice to remember" from "must not miss".
- Prototype the life-event creation flow and Reminder Ladder.
- Run usability tests and compare the proposed experience with a generic reminder experience.
- Refine the MVP scope based on evidence, not feature volume.
- Define the final product strategy, prioritised roadmap and measurable pilot goals.

15 | Why DateNest?

DateNest addresses a relatable problem with both practical and emotional consequences. The product-management value of the concept is not simply building a reminder feature; it is making decisions about user segmentation, information architecture, context, notification design, trust, prioritisation and measurable outcomes.

The strongest version of DateNest is not the app with the largest number of integrations. It is the product that makes an important life event easier to remember and easier to act on. Its success therefore depends on evidence from users and disciplined MVP validation.

16 | Conclusion

DateNest proposes a focused approach to personal life management: bring important dates together, attach the context needed to act, and provide enough advance notice to prepare. The concept is intentionally positioned as a product hypothesis rather than a claim of proven market fit. The next stage is to validate the problem, test the core experience, and use the findings to define the smallest product that can create measurable user value.

SUBMISSION NOTE

This concept note is structured for academic submission and presentation. Product claims that depend on user behaviour, market size, adoption or willingness to pay should be treated as hypotheses until validated with primary research.

17 | References & Research Sources

- YouGov - Birthday forgetting survey (3 September 2024)
- Moonpig Group - Research on forgetting birthdays and anniversaries
- Microsoft Research - Remember, Remember: Exploring Possibilities for Digital Reminder Systems
- IIM Udaipur - Executive Education
- IIM Udaipur - Faculty Directory: Rajesh R Nanarpuzha